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Doctors describe Clancy’s mental state

Psychiatrists tell court about medications, hospital stay

By Shelley Murphy
and Lea Skene
GLOBE STAFF

PLYMOUTH — The day before Lindsay Clancy killed her three children in January 2023, she told a psychiatrist she believed the medications she was taking for anxiety and depression were making her conditions worse, according to testimony Friday at her ongoing murder trial.

It was a concern Clancy expressed repeatedly during her appointments with Dr. Jennifer Tufts over the course of four months, the psychiatrist told the jury, saying that she was worried about side effects.

During that last visit, Clancy

said she had to “force herself to get out of bed and out of the house,” Tufts told the jury, adding that Clancy’s “mood was the same: flat, anxious, no motivation, numb.”

►Controversy erupts over a hot-mic comment. B2.

But, added Tufts, who specializes in women’s health and postpartum care, Clancy showed no signs of psychosis and denied experiencing any suicidal or homicidal thoughts. The psychiatrist increased Clancy’s dosage of a previously prescribed medication to help her sleep.

The next day, Jan. 24, 2023,

Clancy strangled her children with exercise bands and attempted suicide, slashing her neck and wrists before jumping out a second-story window of their Duxbury home. She severed her spinal cord in the suicide attempt and is paralyzed from the waist down.

Several hours of testimony Friday offered jurors the first detailed glimpse into Clancy’s mental state and the psychiatric care she received in the months and weeks leading up to the killings.

Both Tufts and a second psychiatrist who testified on Friday are being sued by Clancy, who alleges they failed to properly

CLANCY, Page A10

Distress can linger for jurors in tough cases

By Emily Spatz
GLOBE CORRESPONDENT

More than a decade ago, Kelley McCarthy sat in a jury box in the John Joseph Moakley Courthouse, listening to the emotional testimony of survivors and victims’ families in the case of Dzhokhar Tsarnaev, one of the men responsible for the Boston Marathon bombing.

Her teeth chattered as she listened to testimony from a survivor who lost her leg.

“That’s what my nervous system was doing to me at the time,” she said.

The high-profile trial left McCarthy, now 59, with nightmares, insomnia, and constant reminders of the violence that killed three and injured hundreds of others. She spent a year and a half in therapy processing what she’d seen, including autopsy photos, videos of the blasts, and remnants of the pressure cooker bombs

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PAUL HEINTZ/GLOBE STAFF

Sarah George is seeking reelection as state’s attorney in Chittenden County, Vt.

Safety in city drives Vermont primary

Candidates differ on security in Burlington

By Paul Heintz
GLOBE STAFF

BURLINGTON, Vt. — Near the start of the summer tourism season, Mayor Emma Mulvaney-Stanak convened a press conference along an outdoor pedestrian shopping mall to make a bold declaration: “Burlington is back.”

For years, this city on Lake Champlain had been hobbled by the perception its downtown was no longer safe. Increases in crime, open-air drug use, and public homelessness had scared off suburban shoppers, and seemingly endless roadwork and construction had further diminished its appeal.

But, the mayor said, standing outside a home goods store, “There’s a growing sense that Burlington is turning a corner, that energy is back, the confidence is returning in the city, and that this city is moving forward.”

Whether that is indeed the case has become a central question in one of Vermont’s most closely watched political races

BURLINGTON, Page A7



Finding a father’s words

As her father developed Alzheimer’s disease, the storyteller the man had been went silent. But then a bag of letters brought an unexpected gift. **Opinion, A8.**

Brockton Mayor Moises M. Rodrigues testified at a clerk magistrate hearing that he has no memory of meeting the teen who has accused him of unwanted contact. **B1.**

A divided federal appeals court ruled that President Trump’s administration must stop construction of the \$400 million White House ballroom because Congress has not approved the project, a decision he blasted as “unjust” while vowing to appeal it. **A2.**

Hot spot

Saturday: Stormy afternoon. High: 86-91. Low: 72-77.

Sunday: Sunny, hot. High: 90-95. Low: 68-73.

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Suggested retail price
\$4.00



Amid concerns about lettuce, keeping things simple — and local — can go a long way



JONATHAN WIGGS/GLOBE STAFF

Little Leaf Farms lettuce is raised in an indoor setup in Shirley that requires little human contact, reducing the chances of contamination. “It’s the cleanest and safest way to make sure there is no harmful biology,” said CEO and founder Paul Sellew. D1.

A complex food chain means more chances for contamination

By Camilo Fonseca
GLOBE STAFF

With cyclosporiasis infections spiking in Massachusetts and across the country, there’s an open question hanging over the supermarket produce aisle: Is any of this safe to eat?

The consequences are not abstract. Cyclosporiasis has been described as causing “miserable” chronic diarrhea, a fate no consumer wants to risk over a store-bought Caesar salad. The outbreak has sickened thousands of people nationwide, and in Michigan, two people have died. And while Massachusetts case numbers are still modest compared to other parts of the country, the 104 cases reported here in July suggest the concern shouldn’t be ignored.

So we asked experts: What do consumers need to do to

protect themselves? And should we be afraid of our salads?

What shoppers need to know

“For what’s worth, I haven’t changed my diet significantly,” said Dr. Zoe Weiss, director of microbiology at Tufts Medical Center.

Weiss pointed out that federal officials have linked the national outbreak to iceberg lettuce from Mexico. Taylor Farms, a California-based produce company identified as a likely distributor of contaminated food, recalled all lettuce sourced from central Mexico last month.

So, is it as simple as skipping anything with a Taylor Farms logo at the grocery store?

Not necessarily. For one thing, investigators have yet to definitively trace the source of outbreak to Taylor Farms — and plenty of the company’s products are, in all likelihood, quite safe.

Investigators have yet to rule out other producers, or other

CYCLOSPORIASIS, Page A6